PITCH DECK | DEEPGRAM SENIOR MANAGER, DEAL DESK

A usage-based voice platform selling self-serve, enterprise and marketplace deals at once needs a desk that answers same-day, not a control function that slows Sales down. I have built that desk once already, and run the margin discipline behind it twice.

Approval matrix and playbook design, discount governance, CPQ build-out, deal-margin insight, and an AI agent that takes the first pass so the human call is the one that matters.

- **PriceKeel**: a guardrail engine built from scratch that governs discount exceptions
- **$700K+** in margin recovered in 2 quarters negotiating discount exceptions
- **53% to 61%** distributor margin lift through channel repricing
- **$627M** pipeline, 1,200 opportunities, scored by win rate and discount band
- **Claude AI agents** running first-pass analysis today at Applied Materials

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WHY THIS DECK EXISTS

Building a deal desk from zero is not a staffing problem. It is a design problem: get the rules wrong and the desk becomes the bottleneck it was supposed to remove.

What a ground-up desk runs into

Self-serve, enterprise commitments and marketplace deals each need a different approval path, so one playbook has to flex without turning into three sets of exceptions.

Without a pre-approved matrix, every non-standard deal becomes an executive-review meeting, which is the opposite of helping Sales win faster.

Deal margin and realized discount have to be visible by segment before anyone can say which discounts are actually defensible, not just which ones felt reasonable.

What I have already built and run

At **PriceKeel**, I designed the guardrail engine itself: a rule set that reads a live discount exception against a company's own closed-won and closed-lost deals and recommends an explainable path.

At **Sensata**, I ran the margin side at scale: $700K+ recovered in 2 quarters and distributor margins lifted 53% to 61%, both decided deal by deal against documented competitive and willingness-to-pay data.

At **Applied Materials** now, AI agents built on Claude take the first pass on repetitive pricing analysis so my call is the one that moves the deal, the exact loop this desk needs.

This req asks for an approval matrix and playbook most deals never need, same-day answers on the rest, deal-margin and discount-band visibility, audit-ready records in Salesforce, and an AI agent doing the first-pass review. That is the guardrail engine, run at Sensata's scale, done again for Deepgram.

THE REQ, MAPPED

What the Senior Manager, Deal Desk opening asks for, and where the proof sits.

What the role covers

> *"Build the desk: approval matrix, pre-approved playbook, and credit and promo guidelines, so most deals need no approval."*

> *"Build pricing insight: deal margin, realized discount, and win rate by discount band."*

> *"Use AI to run the desk: an agent does the first-pass review; you make the call and improve the rules. Build out CPQ in Salesforce."*

My Proof

PriceKeel's guardrail engine: an explainable rule set built from a company's own closed-won and closed-lost deals, the approval-matrix logic this req is asking to build from zero.

Bleeders and Leakers at Sensata: 1,200 opportunities scored against a $627M target with win rate and stage distribution by salesperson and product line, surfacing $433M in margin gaps.

Claude AI agents at Applied Materials: first-pass automation on repetitive pricing analysis today, the same agent-reviews-then-I-decide loop this desk is built to run.

CRM and CPQ ownership at PriceKeel: set up and run end to end, plus the audit trail that keeps every approval and term ready for Finance to review.

THE SENSATA PROOF, IN DEPTH

Bleeders and Leakers: deal-margin and discount-band visibility across a $627M book.

Built as a BU-wide Power BI system covering 1,200 pricing opportunities against a $627M target across 3 regions, 4 product families and 20 product lines, scored by win rate, avg $/win and stage distribution by salesperson and product line, exactly the deal-margin and discount-band view this req asks the desk to build.

$433M

Margin Gaps Surfaced

Ranked every pricing risk into one view instead of chasing anecdotes deal by deal.

$700K+

Margin Recovered in 2 Quarters

Closed by reviewing non-standard deals and making the call on documented competitive gaps.

53% to 61%

Distributor Margin Lift

A repricing program run through channel partners, the credit-and-promo-guideline half of the same work.

The same seat shaped multimillion-dollar customer quotes and AP26 revenue models alongside senior executives. The thread running through all of it: a playbook that resolves most deals on its own, and a same-day answer on the ones that need a human call.

FIRST 30 DAYS

What the first month building Deepgram's deal desk looks like.

WEEK 1

Map deal margin and realized discount by segment

Sit with Sales, Customer Success and Finance to build one view of deal margin, realized discount and win rate across self-serve, enterprise and marketplace deals, the same first move behind the Bleeders and Leakers dashboard at Sensata.

Why first: an approval matrix is only as good as the margin data it is built on.

WEEK 2-3

Ship the approval matrix and playbook

Draft the pre-approved playbook and credit and promo guidelines so most deals clear without review, and start giving same-day answers on the non-standard ones, the guardrail-engine logic already built once at PriceKeel.

Why now: building the matrix against real deal data, not in a vacuum, is what made the 53% to 61% distributor gain hold at Sensata.

WEEK 4

Stand up the AI first-pass and start the CPQ build

Put an AI agent on first-pass review of non-standard deals so the human call is the one that counts, and begin building the playbook and approvals into Salesforce CPQ so they live in the quote.

Why this fast: the same habit that keeps Claude agents running recurring pricing analysis at Applied Materials today.

CLOSE

You are hiring someone to build a deal desk from zero. I have built the rule set that governs discount exceptions from zero already, and run the margin discipline behind it at a much larger scale.

The core proof is Sensata: **$700K+ recovered in 2 quarters** and a **53% to 61% distributor margin lift**, both run through a deal-margin and discount-band system built against a $627M-opportunity Power BI pipeline.

What is harder to find is someone who has also designed the desk's own rule set: at **PriceKeel** I built the guardrail engine that explains a discount decision to Finance, and at **Applied Materials** I run Claude AI agents on the first pass of repetitive pricing analysis every day, the exact pairing this req asks for.

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